

## Mundu Radio

### Internet radio on your mobile: sound cool?

Listening to music on mobile phones while travelling has become one of people's favourite pastimes all across India. The sudden blossoming of radio stations everywhere has contributed to this trend. The creators of Mundu Radio believe streaming music from Internet radio stations could be the Next Big Thing. (Geodesic is the company that makes software for mobile devices with the "Mundu" name; we tested one of their other products—Mundu IM—a while ago.)

We tried out the Symbian OS version on a Nokia N70. The interface is colorful and elegant. Stations are stored by genre. There are some preset stations, and you can add more manually through their site, [www.radio.mundu.com](http://www.radio.mundu.com). Also, the default playlist, which contains all the stations, can be updated from your account on the Mundu Radio site. Recently-played stations can be viewed

quickly from a list that updates itself when you play a new station. We must say it would be nice to be able to add stations directly through the software interface instead of having to log in to the Mundu Radio site to add stations to your list.

We used a GPRS connection to access the streams on Mundu Radio; you can use Wi-Fi as well—if your phone supports it. The streams we used were 32 Kbps and 24 Kbps, and the performance was quite decent—they sounded good enough for a mobile phone. There was, however, a lot of buffering even with the slightest drop in signal strength. The other concern, if at all, is the rates at what

you are billed for downloads. For example, using a 32 Kbps radio stream for an hour will result in around 14 MB of data transferred.

There are lots of Internet-based radio stations, and you have no shortage of music to choose from. Mundu Radio is currently a free beta and upgrades can be downloaded from their site. How good the experience will be will eventually come down to the quality of service of your provider, and also the schemes suitable for long periods of radio listening. Either way, it's a great concept that can be implemented on the current infrastructure without

hassles, and it's definitely worth trying out. Mundu Radio is currently available for Palm, Symbian 7 and 8, and Windows Mobile devices.

Contact: Geodesic Information Systems Ltd  
Phone: 022-28311849, 28306837  
E-mail: [enquiry@mundu.com](mailto:enquiry@mundu.com)  
Web site: [www.mundu.com](http://www.mundu.com)  
Price : Working beta; currently free



| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Features        | ★★★★☆ |
| Ease of Use     | ★★★★☆ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★★ |
| Overall         | ★★★★☆ |

## Norton 360 All-In-One Security

### Security simplified

Norton's latest product—the 360 All-In-One—is a complete security solution. The interface has changed a bit from the earlier software by Symantec; it now has a fancy, sleek, Vista-like theme. The colourful controls should suit beginning computer users.

It looks like Symantec has covered pretty much everything on the security front. You get an anti-virus and a spyware scanner to hunt down viruses, worms, and spyware. There's a firewall, and a Transaction Security feature which is meant to safeguard the online transactions you do—shopping and banking, for example. It verifies whether the sites are online scams or authentic.

The Tune-Up feature is very basic; its task is to

clear out your Windows and Temporary Internet Files and defragment your disk(s). You can set the software to automatically back up important files like the stuff in your My Documents folder and others. Schedules can be set for this.

You get 2 GB of online space that can be used to back up important data: once you've activated Norton 360, you register for the online space.

If Norton 360 finds anything that could hamper



security, it highlights this by displaying it in the main window. For example, if the firewall is disabled, or if the software isn't up to date, it gives out alerts. The software even reminded us that our Windows password wasn't strong enough!

360 All-In-One performed quite a lot better in terms of resources consumed than what we expected having

seen previous Symantec products—like Norton AntiVirus. When idle, RAM consumption was a mere 8 MB. With the interface on, it went up to 17 MB, and it was 75 MB while running the barrage of scans.

All in all, Norton 360 All-In-One Security as a complete security solution does make some sense. The software's focus is ease of use, so it cannot be compared to full-fledged anti-virus software or spyware detectors. Everything is automated, so it's great for those who don't want to be bothered with checking for viruses and backing up data frequently.

Contact: Ingram Micro India (P) Ltd  
E-mail: [deenu.m@ingrammicro.co.in](mailto:deenu.m@ingrammicro.co.in)  
Web site: [in.symantecstore.com](http://in.symantecstore.com)  
Price: Rs 3,699 (3 licenses per household; 2 GB online storage)

| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Features        | ★★★★★ |
| Ease of Use     | ★★★★☆ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★☆ |
| Overall         | ★★★★☆ |